



673,658 posts analyzed

LinkedIn *Study*

Benchmarks • Trends • Performance Data

2026



metricool

A snapshot of 2026

metricool

+5%

Clicks per post

+63%

Higher
engagement on
Personal Profiles

Impressions on
Company Page
posts with links

+51%

+14%

Engagement

-17%

Comments

More *interactions*
from carousels
than images

11x

>10k

Personal Profiles
outperform
Company Pages

+77%

Comments when posts
include a question

48_h

Half of a post's
lifetime impressions
happen here

LinkedIn isn't just a social network for job hunting anymore, it's the place where conversations between professionals happen.

And because of that, it's becoming a bigger and bigger part of brands' social media strategies. Over the past year, LinkedIn accounts connected to Metricool grew by 88%.

But how are brands using it? And what's working on the platform in 2026? To find out, we analyzed nearly 65,000 accounts, including both Personal Profiles and Company Pages, and pulled together the trends, formats, and best practices shaping the platform right now.



We're metricool

We believe in data, and that's why we measure it:

to get a real understanding of what's happening on social media. And so do the more than 3.5 million professionals from American Express to a Chicago family-owned real estate company, who use our tool every day to plan, schedule, and analyze their content.

Join them and start taking control of your social media.

Join Metricool now

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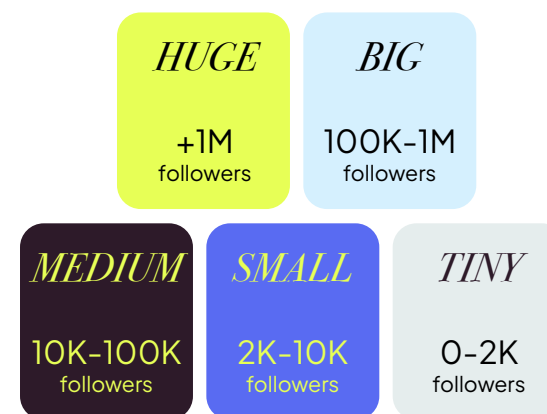
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673,658 *posts from* 63,108 *LinkedIn accounts*

For this study, we analyzed 673,658 posts from 63,108 LinkedIn accounts, covering January–February of both 2025 and 2026 from all around the world.

For the first time in any of our studies, we're including data from both LinkedIn *Company Pages and Personal Profiles*.

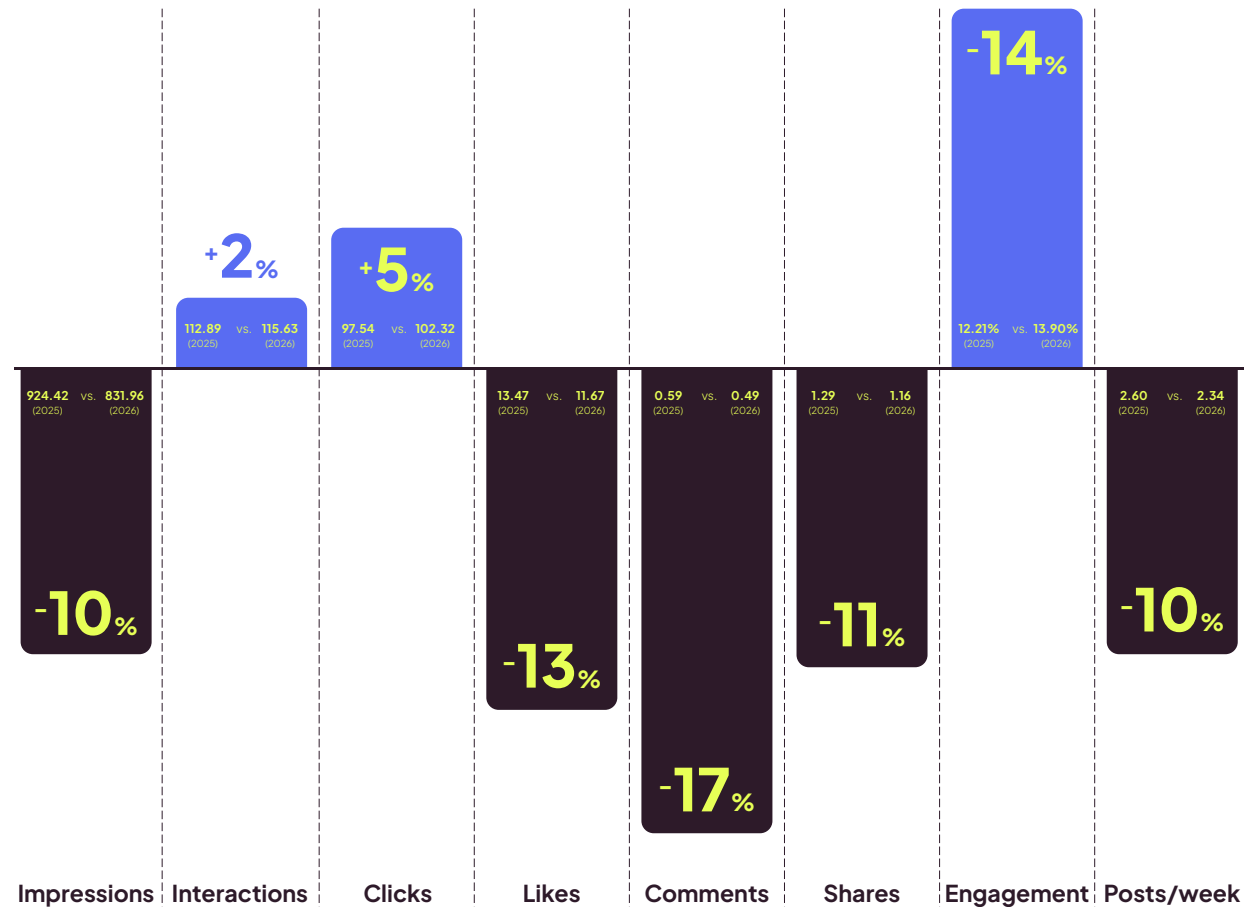
Most of the data in this study is presented as averages (we'll add a note when they're not). To keep those averages as useful as possible, we've grouped accounts by follower count, so you're comparing your page with others at a similar stage, not with accounts that are ten times your size.



The numbers you see on LinkedIn are down but that's not *the whole picture*

Likes, comments, and shares have all dropped compared to last year. On the surface, it looks like the platform is losing steam. But clicks, the interactions that don't show up publicly on your posts, are up, making engagement grow nearly 14%.

People are interacting on LinkedIn more than ever, just in ways that aren't visible to everyone else.



LinkedIn Company Pages evolution (2026 vs 2025)

Not all interactions on LinkedIn look the same

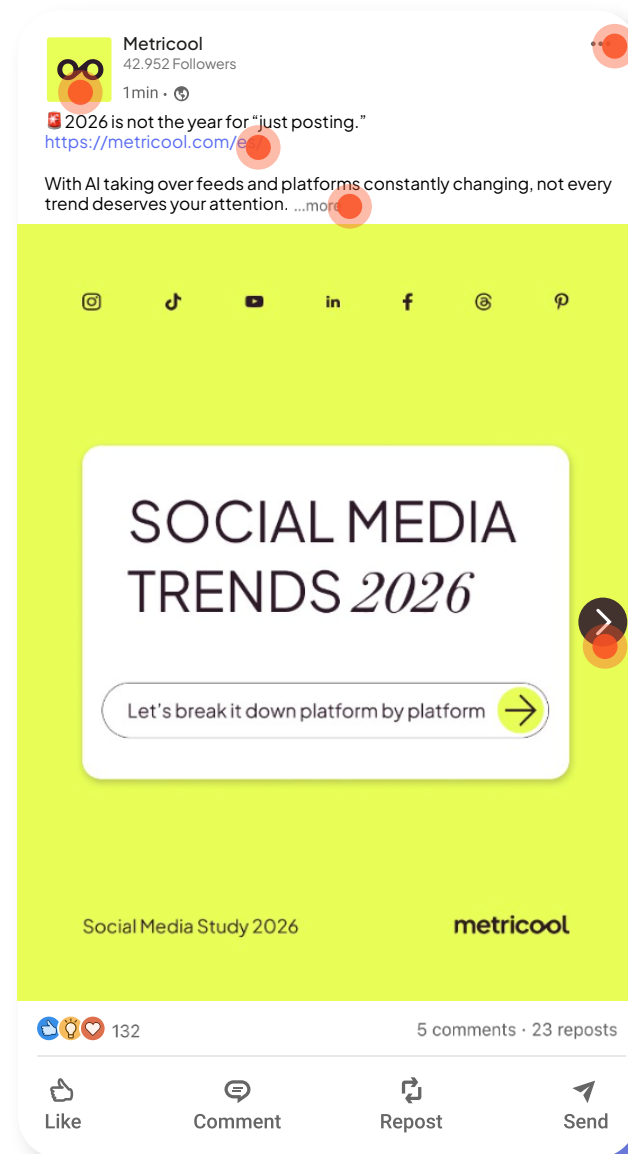
And not all of them are visible.

When someone likes or comments on your post, you see it. But when someone clicks through a carousel, watches a video, or follows a link, that also counts as an interaction. LinkedIn tracks it, the algorithm weighs it, but nobody walking past your post would ever know it happened.

All these clicks are invisible interactions, and they matter. A lot.

The Like button has been the default way to measure content performance since Facebook introduced it in 2009. That's almost 20 years ago. Social media looked completely different back then; the apps, the formats, the reasons people logged in. A 13-slide carousel didn't exist, and swiping through one certainly didn't count as engagement. But it does now, because it is engagement, whether or not anyone pressed a button.

LinkedIn has caught up to that reality, at least for Company Pages, and clicks are factored into engagement calculations.



The personal voice *outperforms* the brand voice

Company Pages and Personal Profiles average roughly the same number of impressions per post, but personal accounts generate more interactions, resulting in a 63% difference in engagement rate.

Company Pages

Personal Profiles

+2%

Impressions

831.96 Company
817.67 Personal

Interactions

13.31 Company
14.44 Personal

+8%

Engagement

1.60% Company
2.60% Personal

+63%

Posts/week

2.34 Company
3.05 Personal

+30%

LinkedIn Company Pages vs. Personal Profiles in 2026

Brands get *shares*, people get *replies*

Personal accounts get 238% more comments per post than Company Pages, but Company Pages get shared nearly 15 times more.

These aren't contradicting each other. Brand content feels credible and safe to repost, so people share it. Personal content feels relatable and sparks conversations.

Company Pages

Likes

11.67 Company
12.71 Personal

Comments

0.49 Company
1.65 Personal

Personal Profiles

+9%

+237%

Shares

1.16 Company
0.08 Personal

+1,350%

LinkedIn Company Pages vs. Personal Accounts in 2026 (Average Interactions)

Note: When comparing Company Pages and Personal Profiles, clicks are removed from interactions to normalize the data and make it comparable.



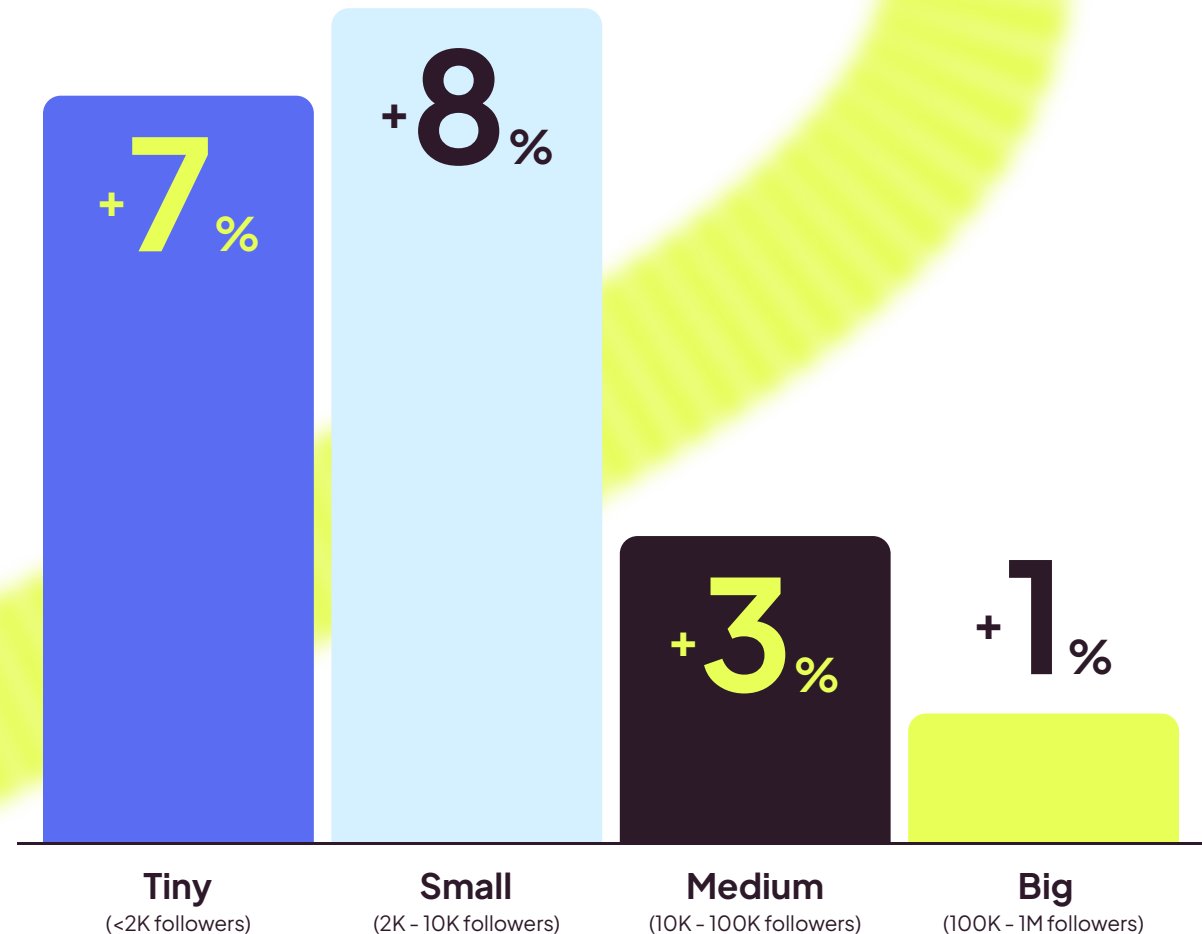
7%

of LinkedIn Company Pages
grew last year

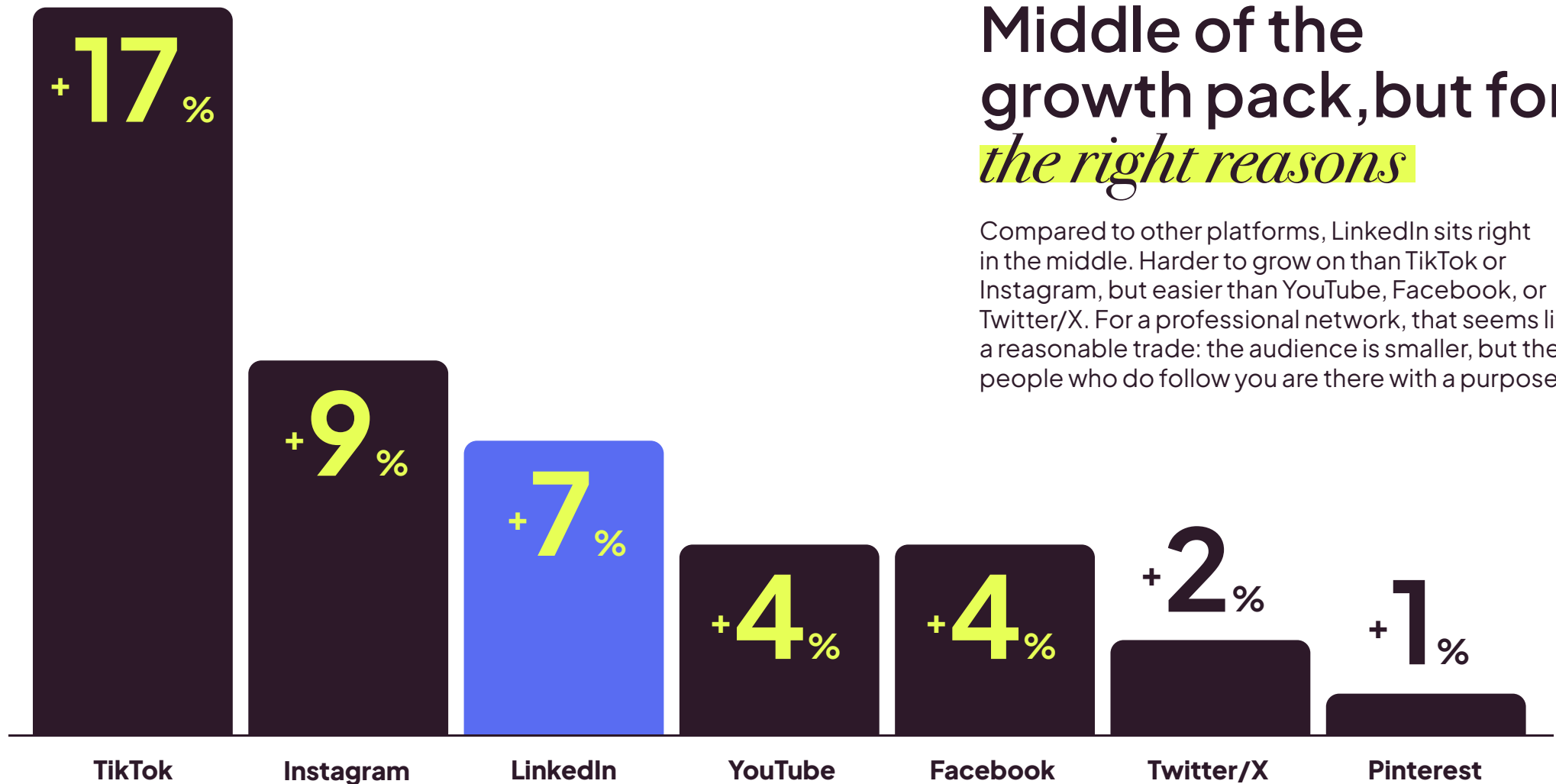
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Growing on LinkedIn is *hard* (unless you're small)

The data confirms that growing on LinkedIn is not easy; only 6.89% of Company Pages gained followers in this period. But that number looks different depending on where you are. Tiny and small pages actually outperform the overall average, with growth rates of 7.13% and 7.97%. Once you cross 10K followers, though, growth slows down considerably.



Percentage of LinkedIn Company Pages that moved to a higher category in 2026



Middle of the growth pack, but for *the right reasons*

Compared to other platforms, LinkedIn sits right in the middle. Harder to grow on than TikTok or Instagram, but easier than YouTube, Facebook, or Twitter/X. For a professional network, that seems like a reasonable trade: the audience is smaller, but the people who do follow you are there with a purpose.

Percentage of accounts that moved to a higher category in 2025, by platform

On LinkedIn, small accounts get a *fair shot*

Impressions grow with audience size, that's expected. But engagement rate stays remarkably consistent across every tier, from pages with a few hundred followers to those with over a million. LinkedIn users engage with content they find useful, regardless of who posted it, and the algorithm doesn't seem to punish you for being new or small.

Every big page started somewhere and LinkedIn doesn't make that harder than it needs to be.

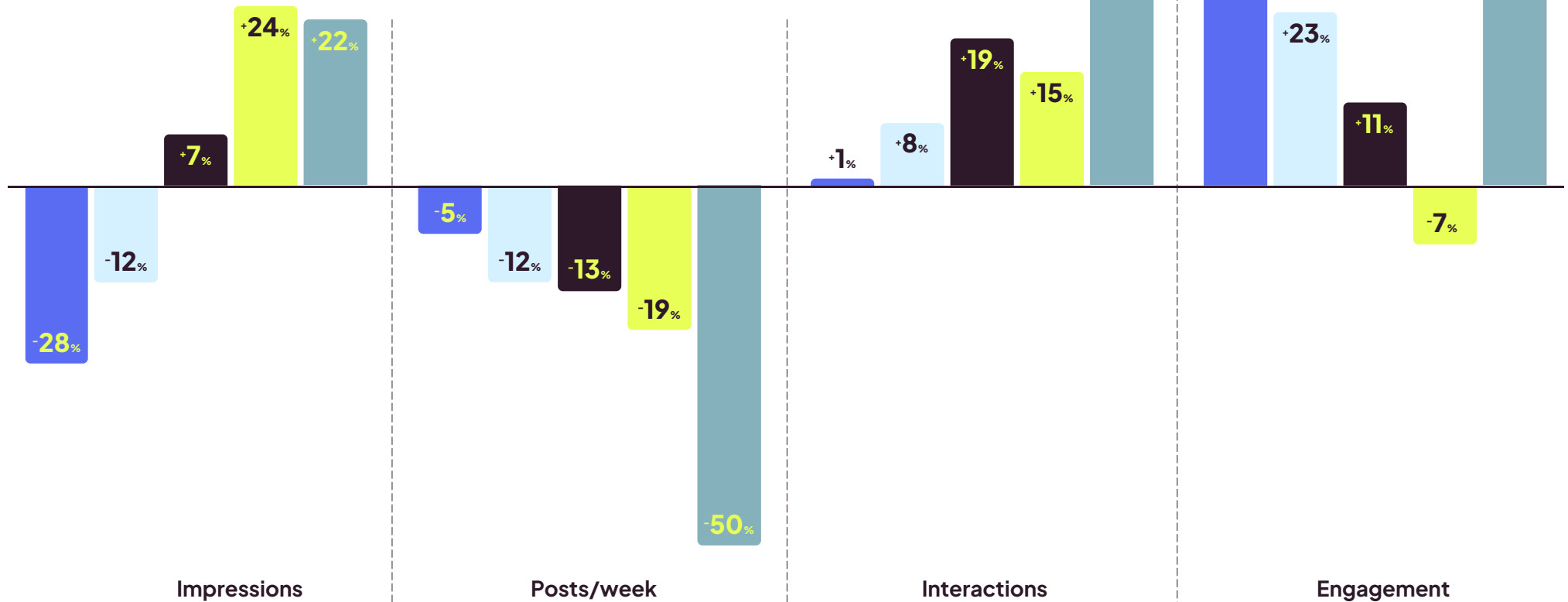
	Impressions	Clicks	Likes	Comments	Shares	Engagement	Posts/week
Tiny (<2K followers)	160.30	19.28	4.21	0.21	0.48	15.09%	1.98
Small (2K - 10K followers)	710.02	93.69	13.80	0.59	1.40	15.42%	2.73
Medium (10K - 100K followers)	2,320.92	290.43	28.38	1.13	2.73	13.90%	4.53
Big (100K - 1M followers)	9,068.55	1,005.67	77.56	2.78	6.42	12.05%	7.68
Huge (>1M followers)	14,888.10	2,370.83	124.02	3.46	11.46	16.86%	14.94

LinkedIn Company Pages in 2026, by account size (Performance by metric)

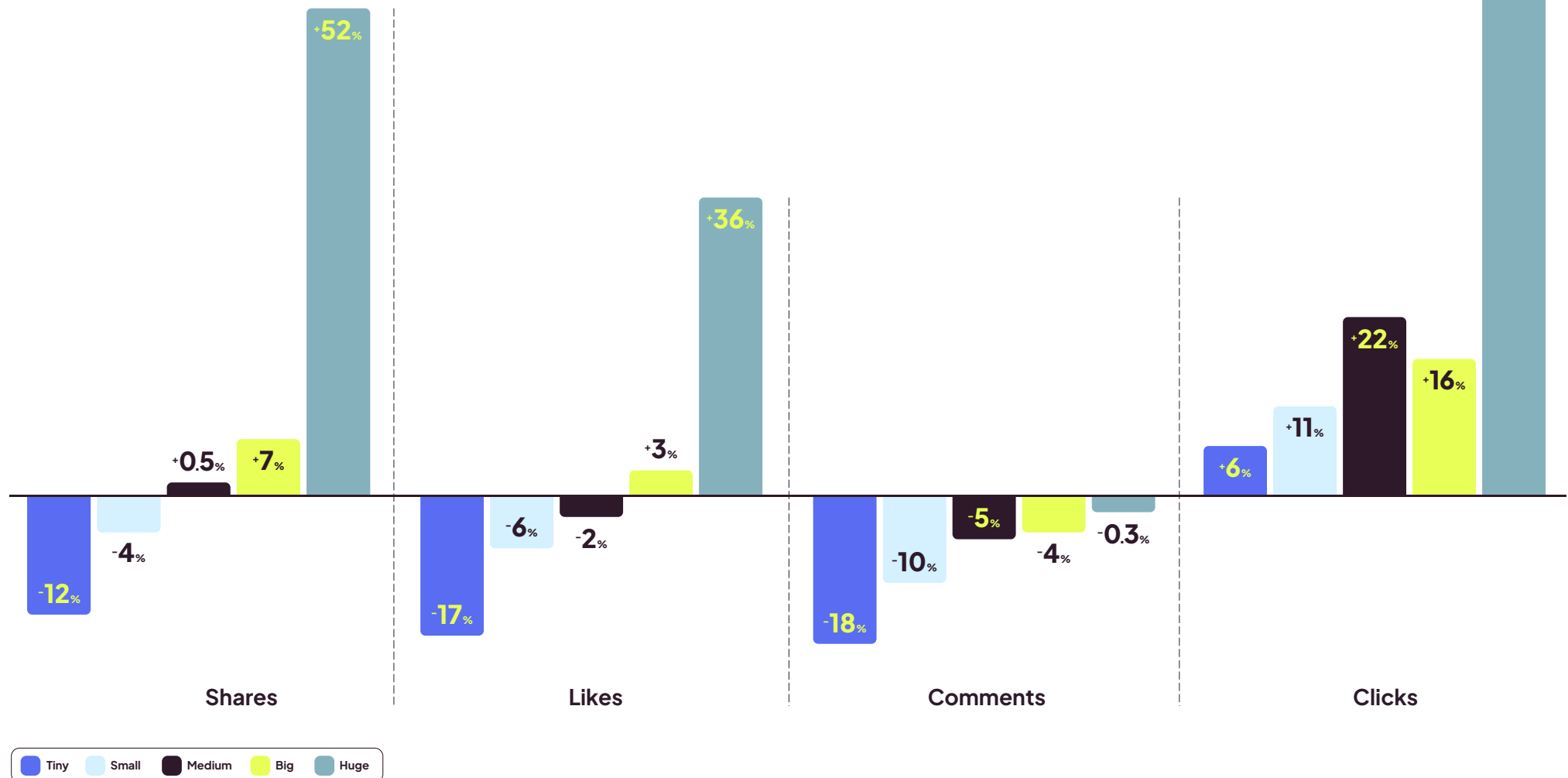
**The engagement rate of
a <2K followers *LinkedIn
Company Page* is 15%.
Almost identical to a page
500× its size.**

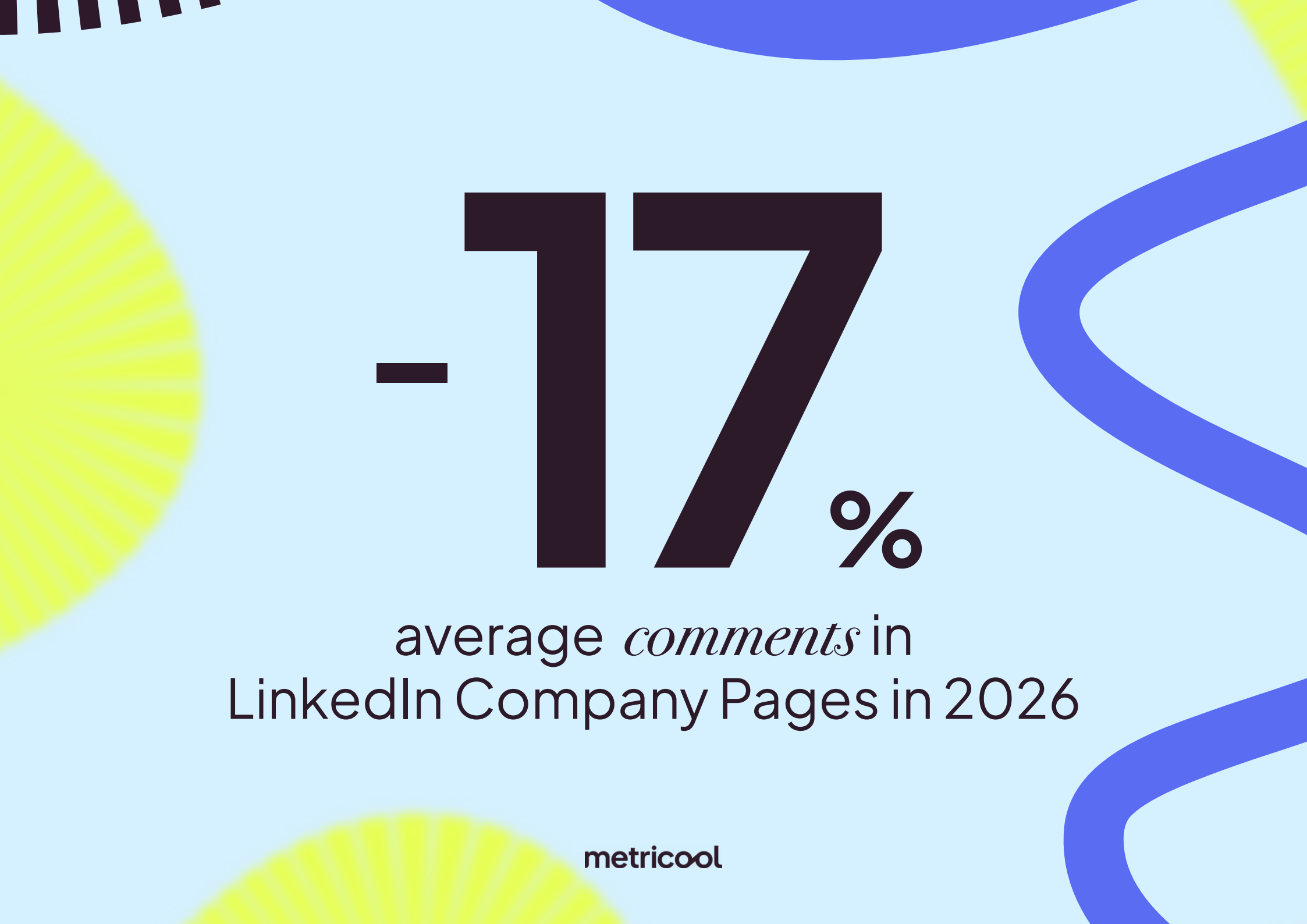
Less content, *more intent*

Posting frequency is down across every account size in 2026, yet clicks are up across the board. People are publishing less, but what they do publish is driving more action. There is one exception worth noting: impressions dropped for Tiny (-27.52%) and Small accounts (-12.19%).



The visible metrics (likes, comments, and shares) are down across most account sizes. But **clicks are up across every single tier**. People are interacting with content differently, not less. This is the invisible interactions story playing out by account size. **The numbers that don't show up publicly on your posts are the ones actually growing.**





-17%

average *comments* in
LinkedIn Company Pages in 2026

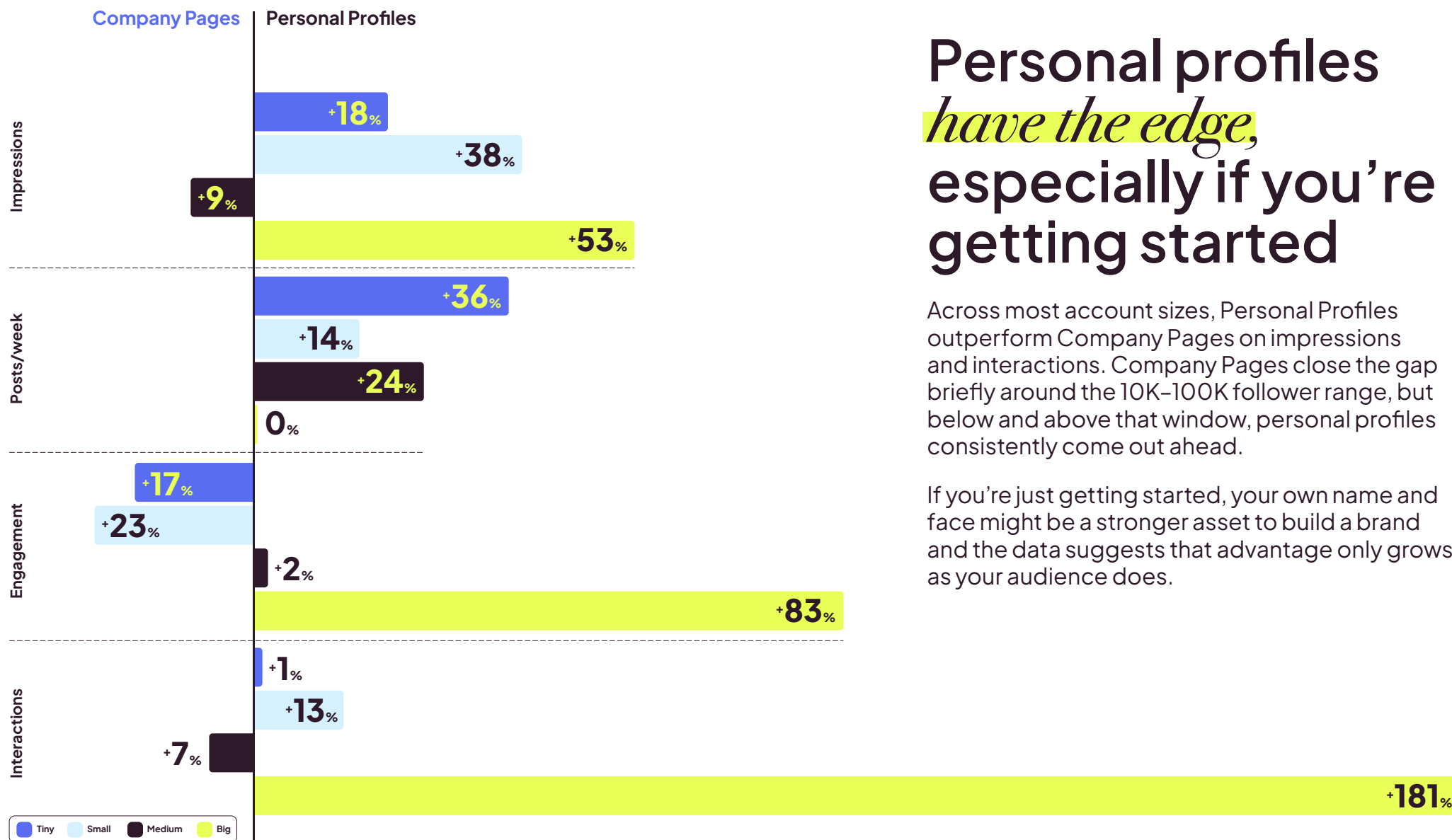
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100K followers is where a personal brand starts *compounding*

Growth on a personal profile follows a gradual curve, impressions, likes, and comments increase steadily at each tier. But once you cross 100K followers, something shifts. Impressions and comments jump 6x and shares jump 14x compared to the previous tier.

	Impressions	Likes	Comments	Shares	Engagement	Posts/week
Tiny (<2K followers)	189.44	4.51	0.41	0.03	2.61%	2.69
Small (2K - 10K followers)	982.17	15.71	2.01	0.08	1.81%	3.11
Medium (10K - 100K followers)	2,122.96	25.87	4.16	0.15	1.42%	5.61
Big (100K - 1M followers)	13,862.36	214.51	26.83	2.19	1.76%	7.68

LinkedIn Personal Profiles in 2026, by account size (Performance by metric)



Personal profiles *have the edge,* especially if you're getting started

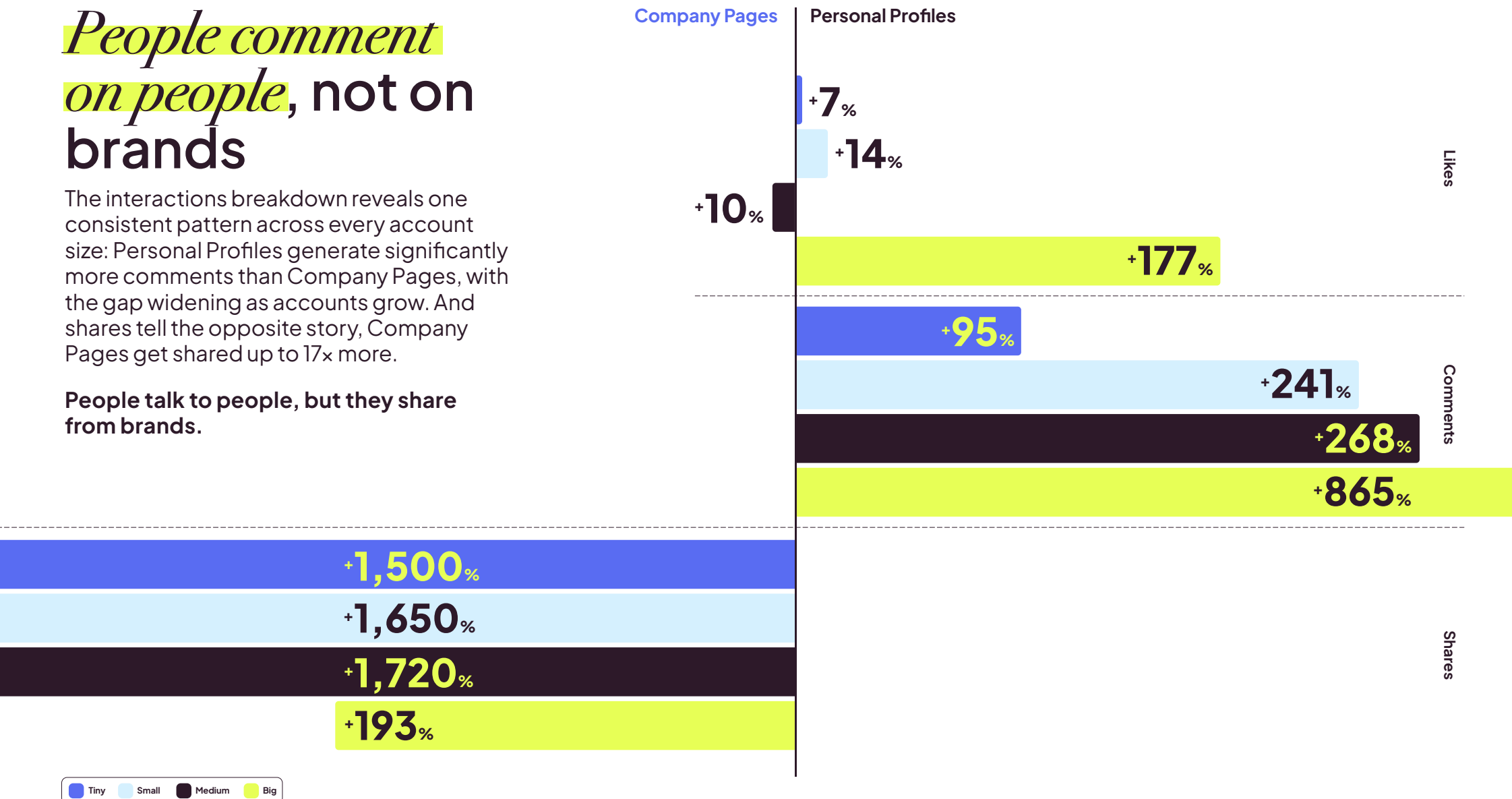
Across most account sizes, Personal Profiles outperform Company Pages on impressions and interactions. Company Pages close the gap briefly around the 10K–100K follower range, but below and above that window, personal profiles consistently come out ahead.

If you're just getting started, your own name and face might be a stronger asset to build a brand and the data suggests that advantage only grows as your audience does.

People comment on people, not on brands

The interactions breakdown reveals one consistent pattern across every account size: Personal Profiles generate significantly more comments than Company Pages, with the gap widening as accounts grow. And shares tell the opposite story, Company Pages get shared up to 17x more.

People talk to people, but they share from brands.

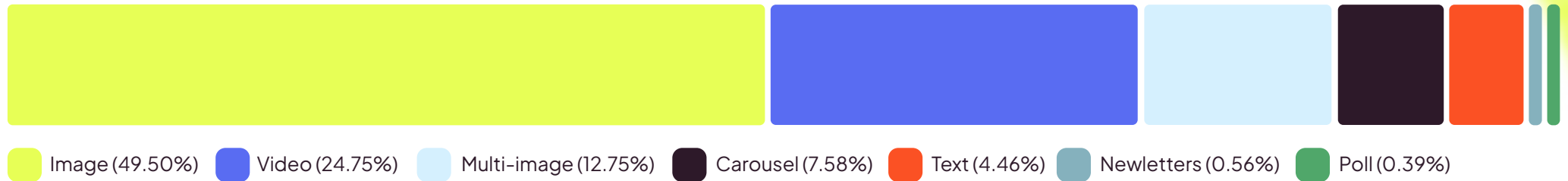


Below 10K followers
Personal Profiles **outperform**
Company Pages **on**
impressions, comments and
engagement.

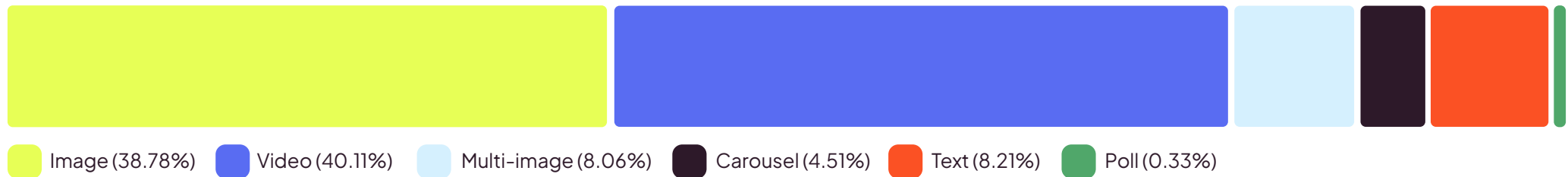
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Most used *formats* on LinkedIn

by *Company Pages*

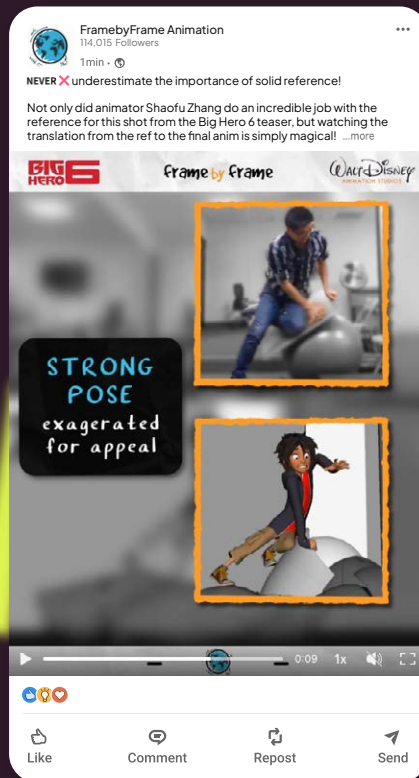


by *Personal Profiles*



The most used format
on LinkedIn by *Company
Pages* is image (49%)
and by *Personal Profiles*
is video (40%).

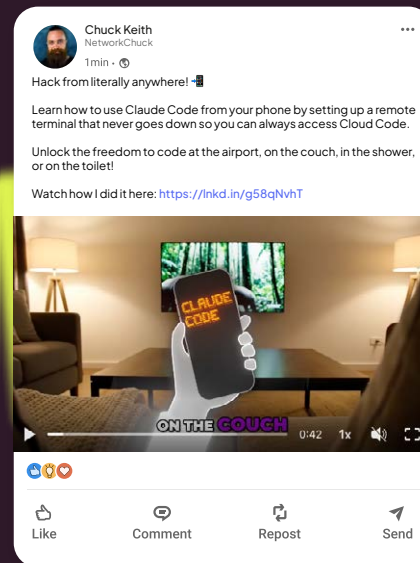
Tip: Video works on LinkedIn too



FramebyFrame Animation

Industry: Fine Art

Followers: 113K



Chuck Keith

Industry: E-Learning

Followers: 497K



How to nail your next video:

Solve a need or spark curiosity for your target audience

Keep it short: tell your story in under a minute

Use hooky elements: captions, visual cues, sounds, and more

Underused, *overperforming*

Image and video account for nearly 75% of all posts on LinkedIn, yet they sit at the bottom of almost every performance metric. **Carousels and multi-image posts generate more impressions, interactions, and engagement**, and polls reach nearly 3x more people per post than any other format despite being the least used of all.

	Image	Video	Multi-image	Carousel	Text	Newsletter	Poll
Impressions	952.90	667.87	1,005.91	1,234.18	649.89	648.27	3,418.57
Interactions	54.98	46.176	380.48	611.15	41.33	27.96	143.98
Clicks	39.14	34.03	359.60	593.97	34.74	14.51	138.65
Likes	13.87	10.62	18.93	14.65	5.79	11.77	4.06
Comments	0.64	0.41	0.61	0.56	0.26	0.61	0.76
Shares	1.33	1.11	1.34	1.98	0.53	1.08	0.50
Engagement	5.77%	6.91%	37.82%	49.52%	6.39%	4.31%	4.21%
Posts/week	1.26	0.98	0.64	0.63	0.48	0.48	0.41

Tip: Keep them swiping



Grad Girl Marketing

Industry: Marketing

Followers: 230K



International Coaching Federation

Industry: Non-profit Organizations

Followers: 368K



The key elements of a good carousel:

Hook people from slide 1: clear idea, surprising fact etc.

Give a purpose to every slide: people need a reason to keep swiping.

Make it appealing: clean design, useful information, minimal text etc.

Last but not least... end with a clear CTA

LinkedIn's *low-hanging fruit*

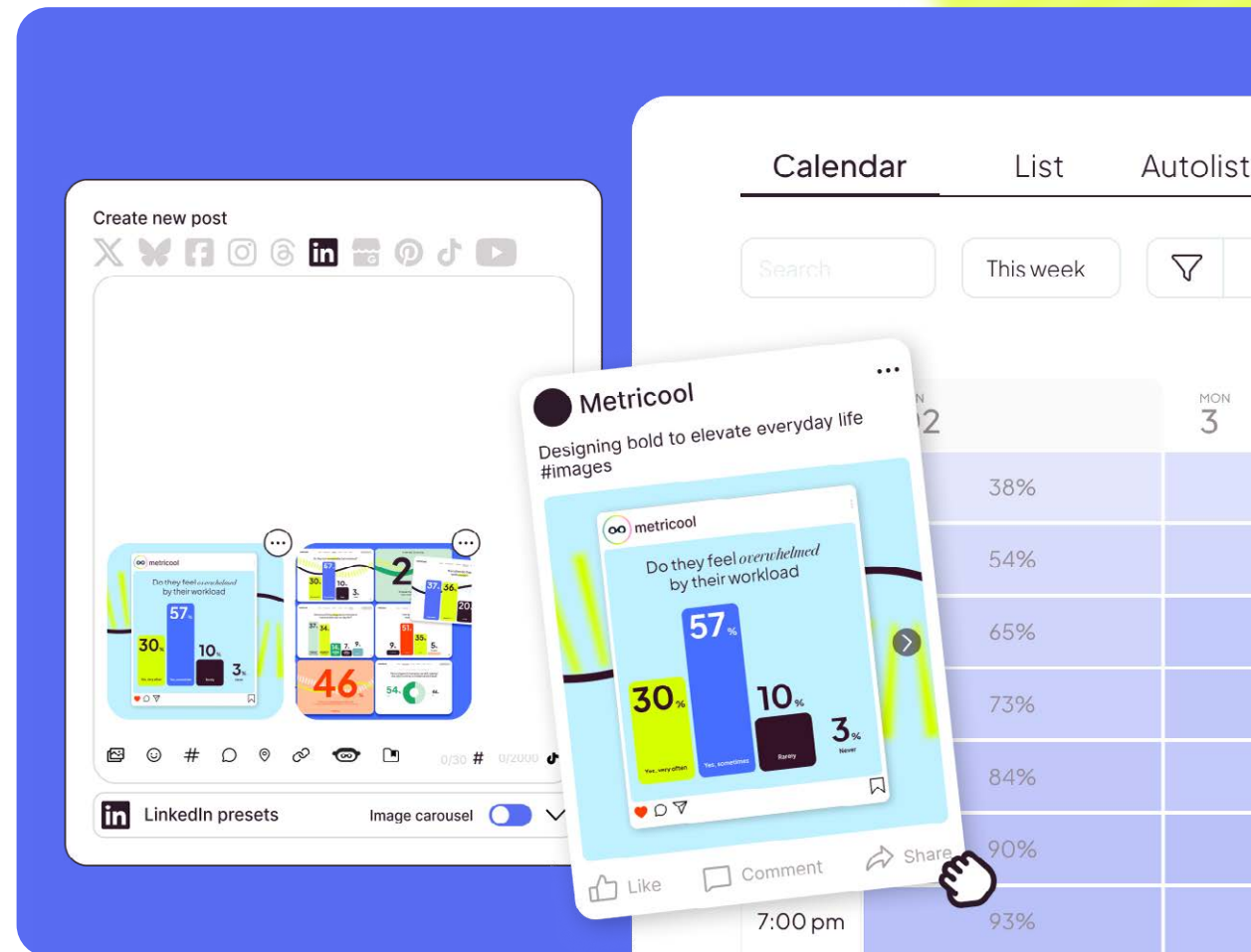
Carousels get 11x more interactions than images, yet images are posted 6x more than carousels.

The reason isn't hard to figure out. Carousels take time: gather images, order them, export to PNG, put them together into a single PDF, upload it, and hope nothing breaks.

Metricool keeps it simple. Just drop your images directly into the planner, reorder them however you want, and post. No PDFs, no headaches, and no reason to keep defaulting to a single image.

Make your next LinkedIn post a carousel.

[Set your Metricool account](#)



Some get the spotlight, while others *steal the show*

Carousels lead on impressions, and single images aren't far behind, but multi-image posts have the highest engagement rate of any format at 3.71%. **Video is the second most posted format, yet sits at the bottom in terms of impressions and interactions.** Frequency doesn't equal performance on personal profiles either.

	Text	Image	Multi-image	Carousel	Poll	Video
Impressions	1,045.15	1,186.74	338.42	1,451.19	717.71	605.57
Interactions	12.20	21.51	12.56	20.86	2.82	10.87
Likes	10.41	18.58	11.65	18.37	2.15	9.83
Comments	1.75	2.80	0.85	2.38	0.65	0.98
Shares	0.04	0.12	0.06	0.11	0.01	0.06
Engagement	1.06%	1.81%	3.71%	1.44%	0.39%	1.80%
Posts/week	2.21	1.67	0.88	0.71	0.75	2.07

Text posts get
2.86x more impressions
on *Personal Profiles* than
on *Company Pages*.

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Which industries are *thriving* on LinkedIn in 2026

Looking at the data, two strategies seem to work, and they're not mutually exclusive.

The first is earning your reach through **engagement**. The sectors with the highest clicks and interactions consistently get more impressions than their follower count would suggest. LinkedIn notices when people act on your content, and rewards it with more visibility.

The second is **volume with discipline**. Tech & Media posts 7 times a week and holds its own on impressions, but their engagement stays consistent. Increasing frequency works, just not without it.

Company Industry	Followers	Impressions	Interactions	Posts/week
Oil, Gas, and Mining	26,987.78	3,103.47	633.65	2.36
Utilities	18,287.34	1,573.91	142.92	2.56
Technology Information Media	11,519.06	1,329.64	141.53	7.18
Financial Services	16,758.58	1,260.87	174.13	2.55
Farming, Ranching, and Forestry	13,434.60	1,242.79	164.03	2.13
Government Administration	10,048.89	1,187.68	142.84	3.60
Education	12,086.15	1,044.46	156.25	3.69
Transportation and Logistics	7,794.87	1,020.06	132.03	2.07
Manufacturing	8,143.92	1,011.88	139.68	1.91
Administrative and Support Services	16,448.74	996.85	139.61	2.33
Accommodation Services	7,105.88	953.67	156.16	1.67
Construction	4,792.48	939.21	171.35	1.81
Consumer Services	6,202.28	821.33	126.94	2.77
Wholesale	4,936.18	691.37	107.67	1.73
Professional Services	6,642.96	680.16	111.37	2.36
Hospitals and Health Care	4,465.01	671.94	76.79	2.54
Entertainment	4,474.55	548.19	67.31	2.42
Retail	5,481.10	529.68	85.26	1.92
Real Estate	2,714.80	271.31	49.83	2.84

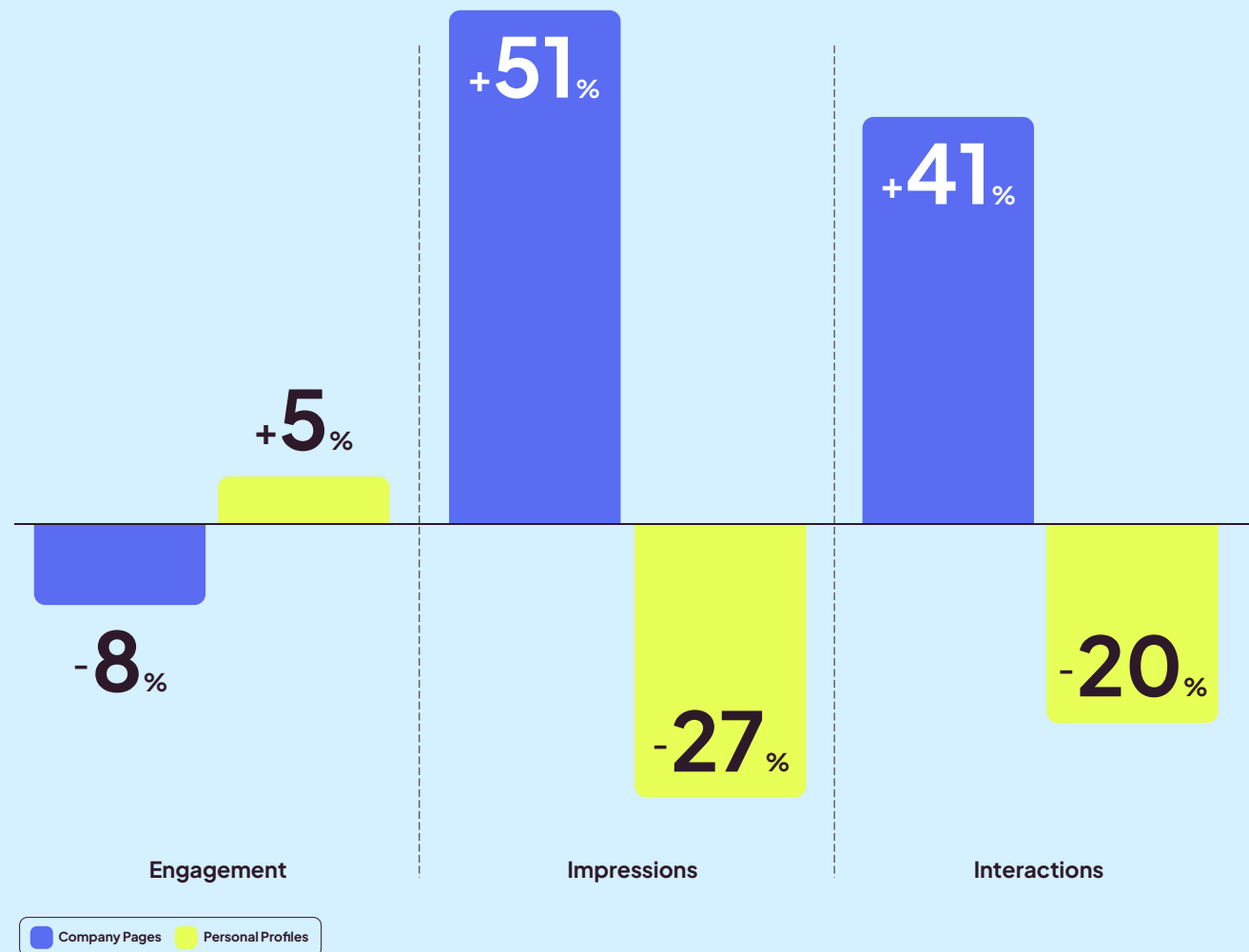
LinkedIn Company Pages average performance by Industry (2026)

Is LinkedIn *penalizing* you for sharing links?

Links hurting your content performance is one of social media's most spread myths. And while we can't completely debunk it, our data says it's not the whole story (and what better platform to test it than the one with "link" in the name).

For Company Pages, it seems not to have a direct negative effect; in fact, our sample shows that posts with links get 50% more impressions and 40% more interactions. On Personal Profiles, the effect flips, and both impressions and interactions drop 27% and 20%, respectively.

Our conclusion is that **a link won't, of course, save a weak post, and it won't sink a strong one either.** If you're going to share a link, make sure the post around it is worth stopping for; relevant, useful, and not trying too hard to sell something. The link is just the door, you still have to make people want to walk through it.



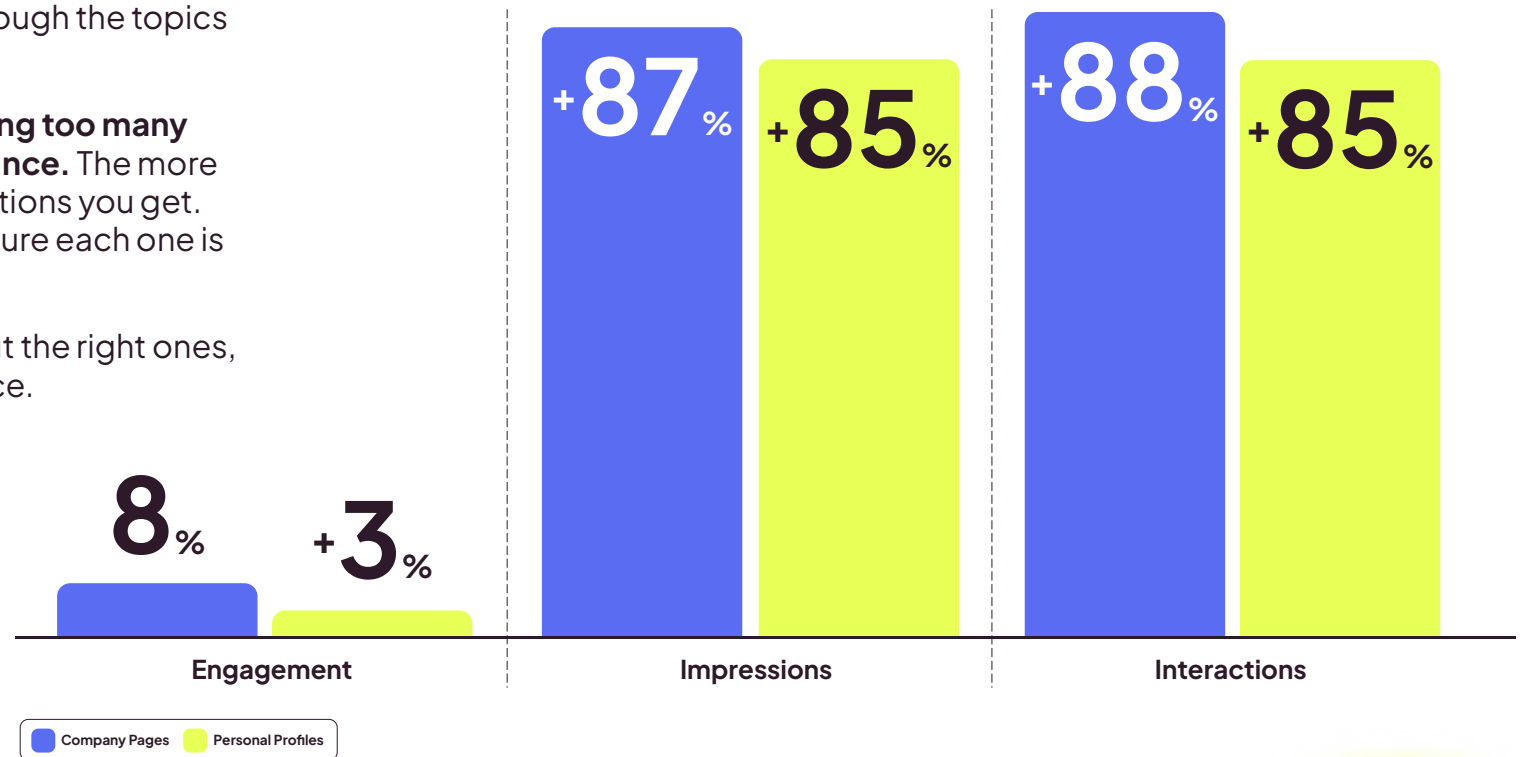
How including a link affects post performance on LinkedIn (2026)

Hashtags still matter

64% of Company Pages and 54% of Personal Profiles include at least one hashtag, and the data backs the habit, because **posts with hashtags outperform the average** across both account types. They help categorize content and make it easier for the right audiences to discover accounts through the topics they care about most.

However, more isn't better here. **Using too many hashtags can affect post performance.** The more hashtags you add, the fewer interactions you get. Keep it between 1 and 5, and make sure each one is relevant to what you're posting.

Hashtags don't guarantee reach. But the right ones, used sparingly, still make a difference.



How including at least one hashtag affects post performance on LinkedIn (2026)

+85%

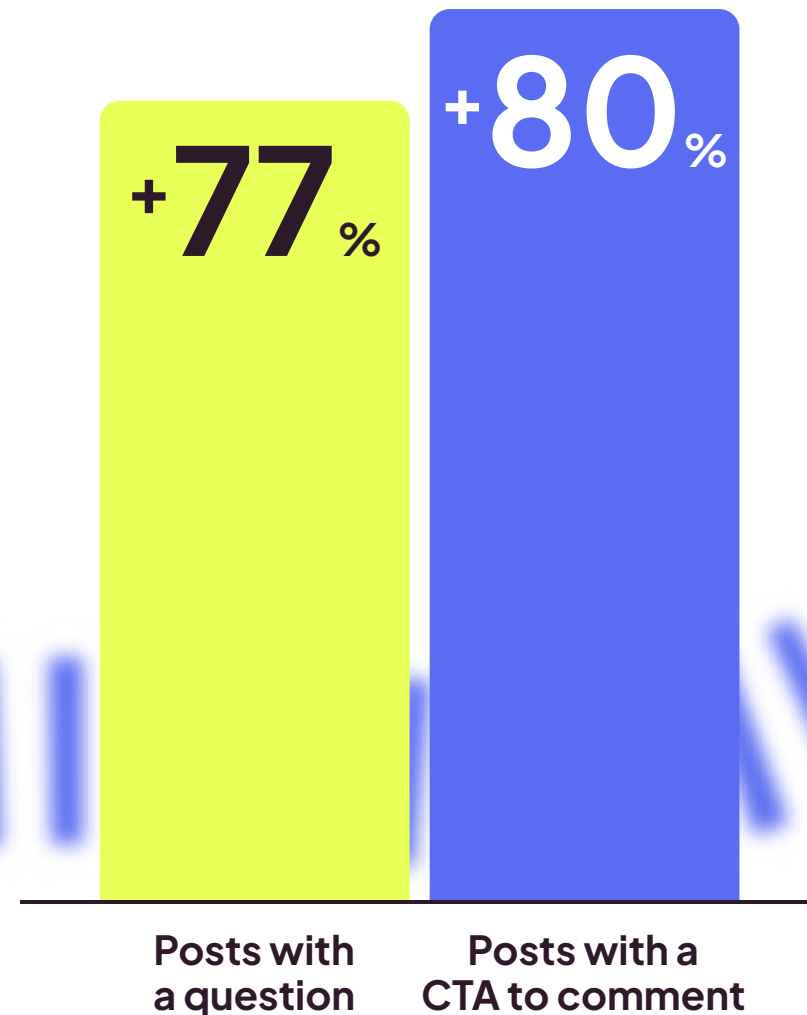
average *impressions* for LinkedIn posts
that include at least one hashtag

Just *ask*

Including questions and incentivising conversation sparks more comments.

People are more likely to join the conversation when there's **a question that gets the discussion going**. The data speaks for itself: posts that include a question drive more comments than posts that don't.

The same happens when you include a **conversation trigger, like asking people to leave a comment**. This significantly increases the number of comments per post, suggesting that users are more likely to engage when they're clearly invited to do so and know exactly how to take part.



LinkedIn average comments: platform average vs. posts with questions or calls to comment (2026)

Tip: Good copy still matters



Juan Valdez Café

Industry: Food and Beverage Services

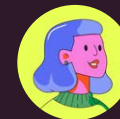
Followers: 409K



Rewilding Europe Federation

Industry: Environmental Services

Followers: 90K



Copy sets the rules:

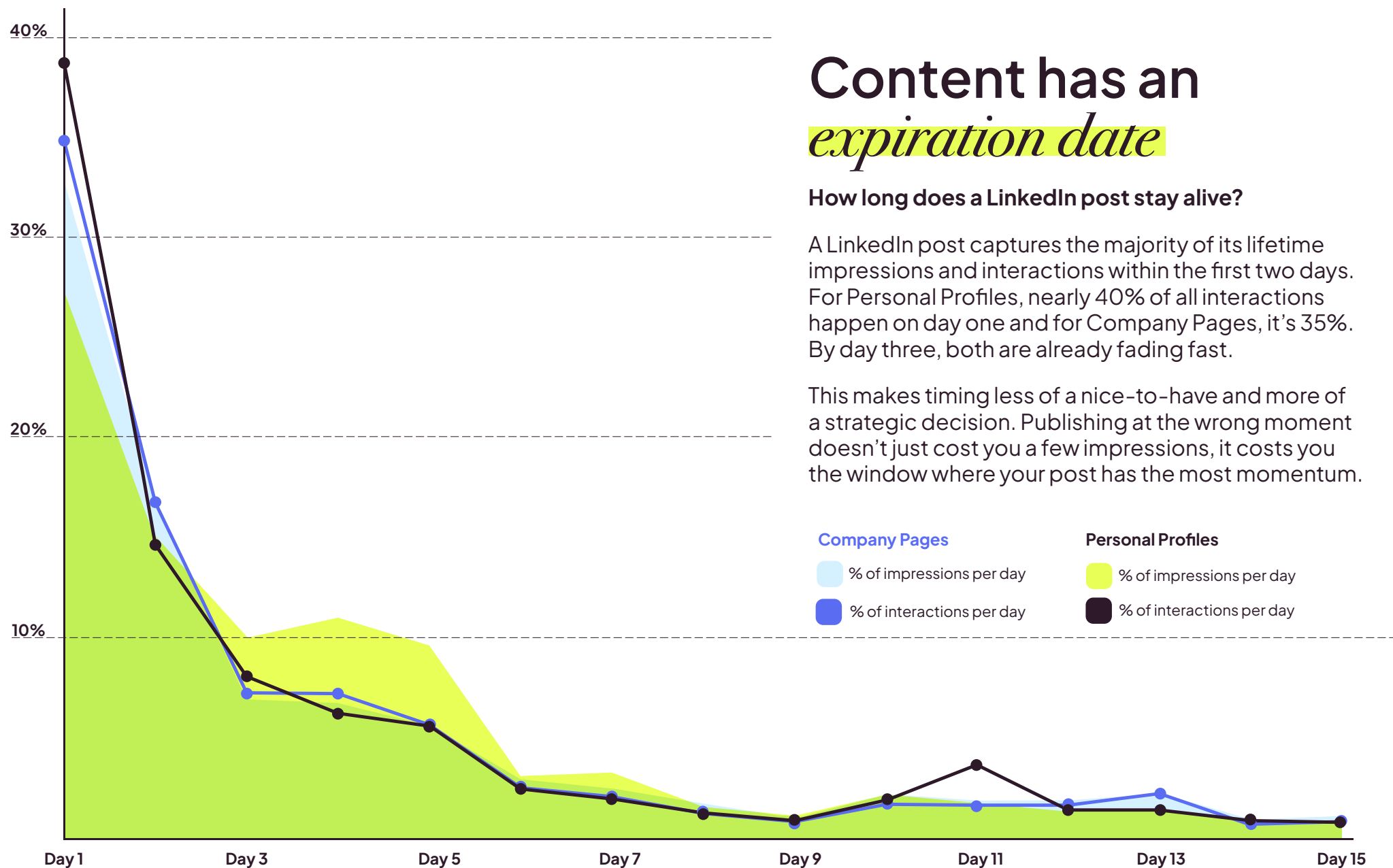
Focus on value rather than quantity: a great storytelling creates emotional connection

Write to be scanned: use short paragraphs, bullet points etc.

Build authority and credibility through your stories

A LinkedIn post
**generates half of its
lifetime impressions
in the first 48 hours.**

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Content has an *expiration date*

How long does a LinkedIn post stay alive?

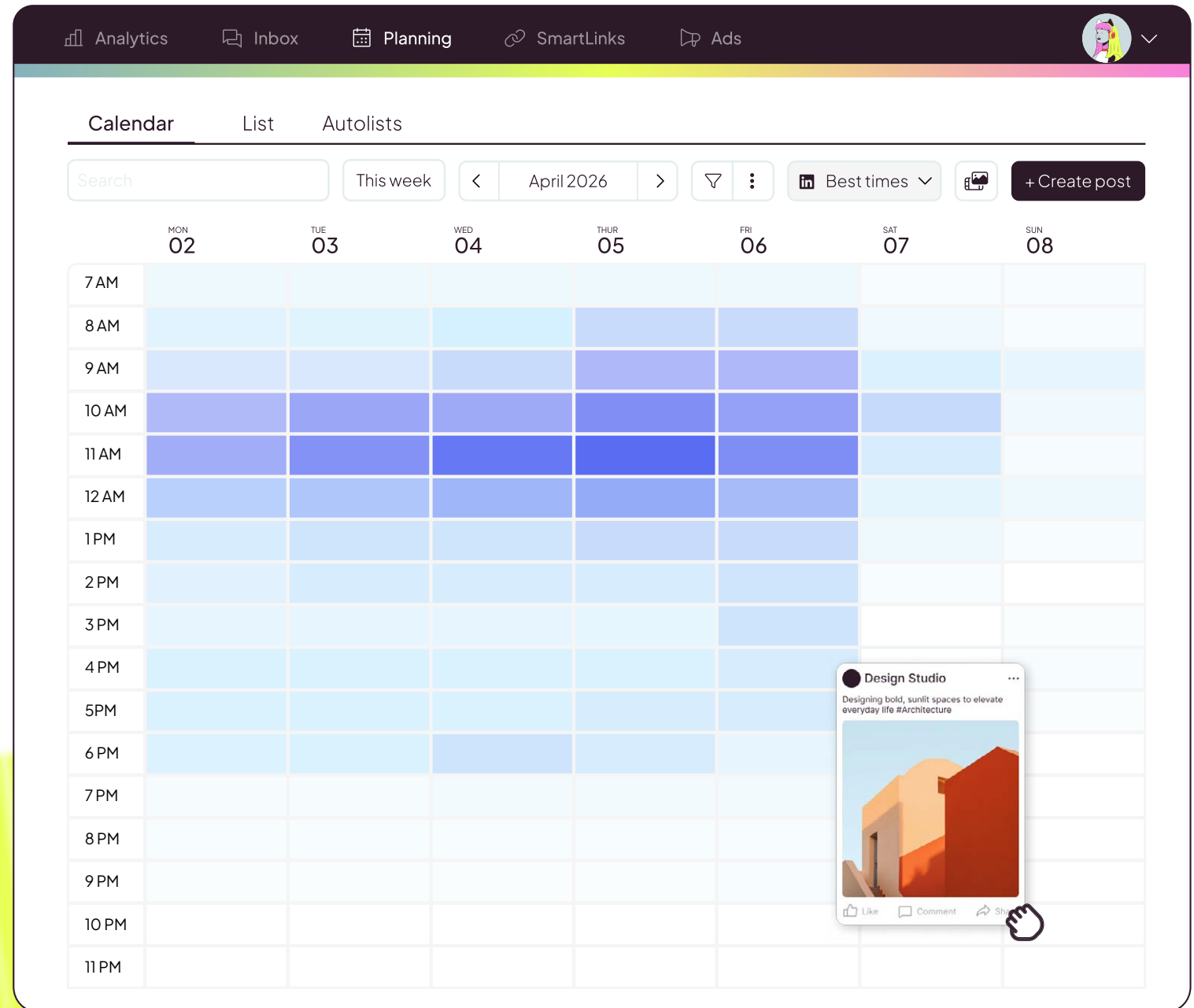
A LinkedIn post captures the majority of its lifetime impressions and interactions within the first two days. For Personal Profiles, nearly 40% of all interactions happen on day one and for Company Pages, it's 35%. By day three, both are already fading fast.

This makes timing less of a nice-to-have and more of a strategic decision. Publishing at the wrong moment doesn't just cost you a few impressions, it costs you the window where your post has the most momentum.

Find your *spot*

The 9 a.m. to 12 p.m. time slot sees the highest number of posts published on LinkedIn, suggesting that most brands have identified it as their go-to posting window.

If you're looking to post during a high-activity period, use it as a reference. If you'd rather avoid the competition, look for less crowded time slots.



Conclusions

- 1** *Personal Profiles outperform Company Pages* on impressions, interactions, and comments at almost every account size. But Company Pages get shared significantly more across every tier, which means they're still essential for amplifying content. The most effective LinkedIn strategy isn't choosing one over the other, but using your Personal Profile to start conversations and your Company Page to spread them.
- 2** *Clicks play a big role* in today's engagement, and they're not always visible. Every time someone clicks a link, watches a video, or swipes through a carousel, LinkedIn is tracking it and factoring it into your content's engagement rate. Optimize for that too.
- 3** Questions and calls for comments *spark conversation*. Posts that include a question get 77% more comments, showing that people are far more likely to jump into the conversation when there's a clear question to respond to.

4 **Timing matters.** Half of a post's lifetime impressions happen in the first 48 hours. Publishing on the wrong day can cost you the entire window where your post has momentum. If a post matters, treat when you publish it as seriously as what you put in it.

5 **Including a link *isn't the problem*.** Links don't automatically hurt your content, but they do change how people interact with it. In B2B especially, a well-placed link to a report, benchmark, or webinar can be genuinely valuable, and the data shows company pages with links actually outperform the average on impressions and interactions. The risk is when links become a habit rather than a choice.

6 **The most popular formats *are leaving a lot on the table*.** Image and video account for nearly 75% of all posts, yet carousels and multi-image consistently outperform them on interactions, engagement, and reach. The gap between what people post and what actually works has never been wider.

Methodology

Sample

All figures are averages per post, unless otherwise stated. Outliers were not removed, but accounts are segmented by follower size throughout the study. This means that accounts with millions of followers going viral won't skew the data for accounts with a few thousand followers. Each tier is analyzed independently.

Accounts with zero publications were excluded from the sample, as were individual posts with zero impressions or zero interactions.

Sample period

The study data covers January–February of 2025 and 2026.

Growth

When we refer to growth, we mean that an account has gained enough followers to move up from one size tier to the next. An account that gained followers but stayed within the same tier is not counted as having grown in this context, not because it didn't make progress, but because the threshold wasn't crossed. This is worth keeping in mind when comparing growth rates across tiers, since moving from Tiny to Small requires fewer new followers than moving from Medium to Big.

Best posting times

Best posting times are calculated based on the activity patterns of LinkedIn accounts connected to Metricool. Higher activity means more users are online and engaging with content during that window, increasing the likelihood your post will be seen. These times reflect when your audience is most active on the platform, not a guarantee of

performance; results may vary depending on your specific audience and industry.

Metrics definitions

Impressions – The number of times your post was shown on LinkedIn. This number is an estimate and may not be precise.

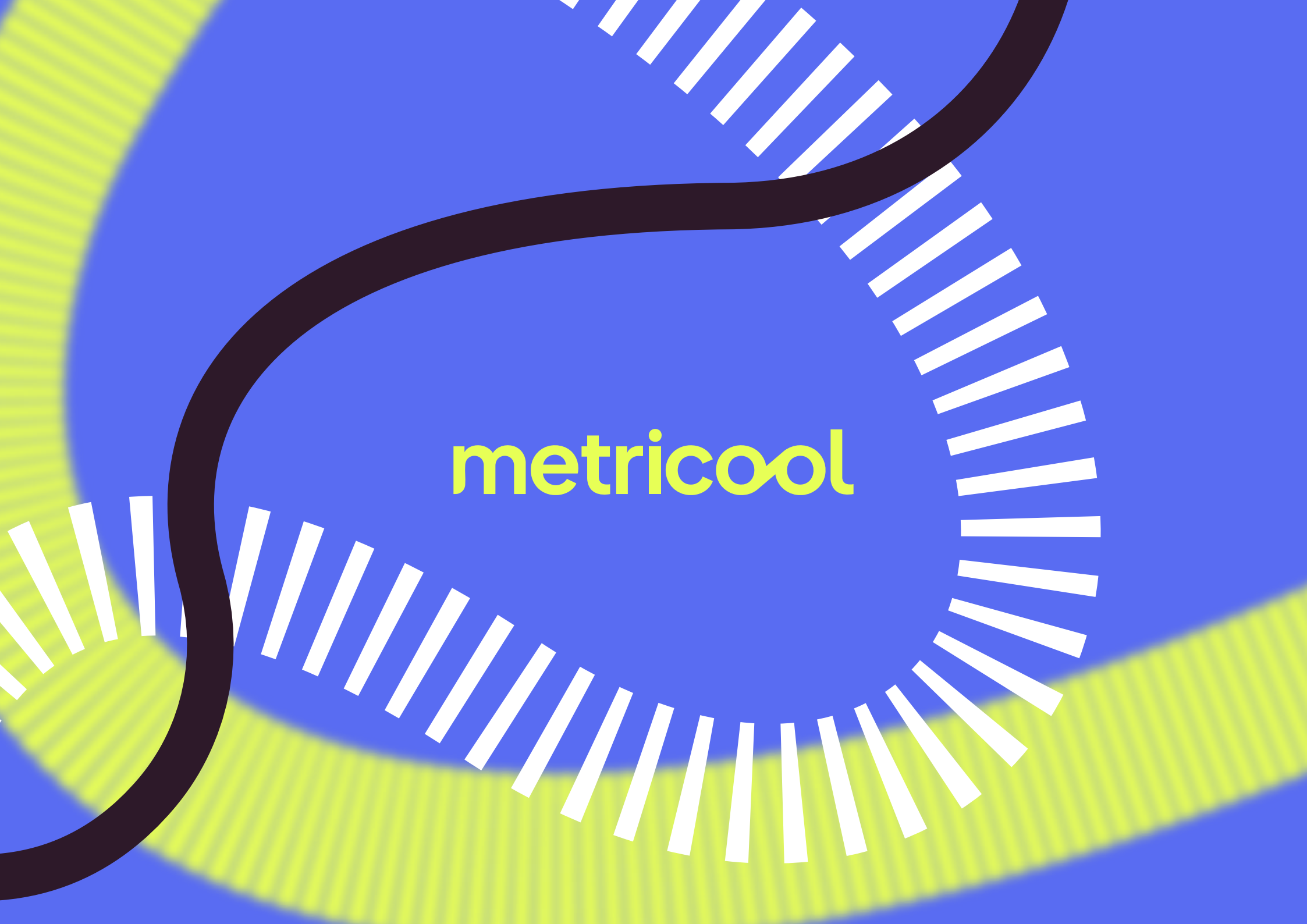
Members reached – The number of distinct members and Pages that saw your post. This number is an estimate and does not include repeat displays.

Clicks – Shows the number of clicks on your content, company name, or logo by a signed-in member. This doesn't include interactions like reposts, reactions, or comments. If a member clicks on a document multiple times, it will count as one click.

Clicks affect both engagement rate and interactions. When analyzing Company Pages in isolation, clicks are included in both metrics. When analyzing Personal Profiles in isolation, clicks are not included since LinkedIn does not track them the same way for personal accounts. Whenever we compare Company Pages and Personal Profiles directly, clicks are removed from the Company Page side to normalize the data and make the comparison fair and meaningful.

Interactions (Reactions, Comments, and Reposts)– Shows the number of reactions, comments, and times your content was shared by members, including Direct Sponsored Content and video posts.

Engagement rate – Shows the ratio of interactions per impressions on a post. Interactions include, reactions, comments, shares, and clicks (for Company Pages only).

The logo features a thick, dark blue wavy line that forms a partial circle around the text. This line is composed of many small, white, rectangular segments that are slightly offset from each other, creating a sense of motion or a digital trail. The background is a solid blue color, with a yellow-green curved band visible on the left and bottom edges.

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